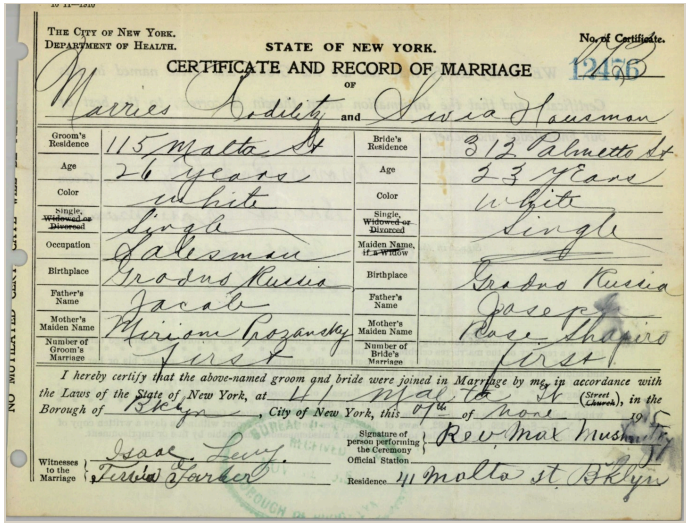
The Rodilitz and Zaslow Families

The families of Theodore Rodilitz and Doris Zaslow, and how they came to America



THE CITY OF NEW YORK. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH.

STATE OF NEW YORK.

No. of Certificate. 12456

CERTIFICATE AND RECORD OF MARRIAGE

OF

Morris Rodilitz and Sivia Hausman

Groom's Residence	115 Malta St	Bride's Residence	312 Palmetto St
Age	26 years	Age	23 years
Color	white	Color	white
Single, ~~Widowed or Divorced~~	single	Single, Widowed or Divorced	single
Occupation	Salesman	Maiden Name, if a Widow	
Birthplace	Grodno Russia	Birthplace	Grodno Russia
Father's Name	Jacob	Father's Name	Joseph
Mother's Maiden Name	Miriom Rozansky	Mother's Maiden Name	Rose Shapiro
Number of Groom's Marriage	first	Number of Bride's Marriage	first

I hereby certify that the above-named groom and bride were joined in Marriage by me, in accordance with the Laws of the State of New York, at 111 Malta St (Street, Church), in the Borough of Bklyn, City of New York, this 07th of Nov 1915

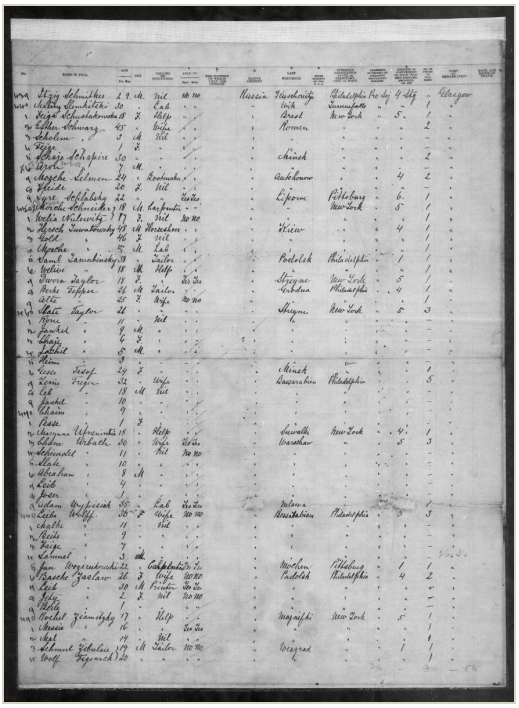
Witnesses to the Marriage: Isaac Levy, Tillie Gordon

Signature of person performing the Ceremony: Rev. Max Muschkin

Official Station

Residence 111 Malta st Bklyn

Brooklyn, 7 November 1915. The marriage certificate of Morris Rodilitz and Sivia (Sylvia) Hausman, Theodore's parents. NYC Municipal Archives.



Ellis Island, 3 July 1893. The *Circassia* passenger list with Basche, Jety and Beile Zaslaw: Doris's grandmother, aunt and mother. Statue of Liberty–Ellis Island Foundation.

Theodore Rodilitz was born in Brooklyn in 1919 and Doris Zaslow in Philadelphia in 1926. All four of their grandparents' families were Jews from the western edge of the Russian Empire: the Rodilitzes and Hausmans from around Kobrin and Brest in Grodno province, with roots in Kovel in Volhynia, and the Zaslows and Saslows from Tulchin and Obodovka in Podolia. They crossed between 1892 and 1925. These notes set out what the records, gathered in October 2026, show about who they were, where they came from, and how each of them reached America.

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● Theodore's side: the Rodilitz and Hausman families ■ Doris's side: the Zaslow and Saslow families

How the four families connect

Theodore Rodilitz and Doris Zaslow took out their marriage licence in Brooklyn on 7 September 1948. He was the son of Morris Rodilitz and Sylvia Hausman of Brooklyn; she was the daughter of Benjamin Zaslow and Catherine Saslow of Philadelphia. Behind them stand four immigrant families, two on each side.

On Theodore's side, the **Rodilitzes** came from the Kobrin and Brest district of Grodno province, now in Belarus, with roots in Kovel in Volhynia, now in Ukraine. Jacob Rodilitz, a Hebrew teacher and the son of Yonah, went to America first, in 1907; his wife Mary, daughter of Abraham Prozansky, and their eight children followed over the next six years. The **Hausmans**, Sylvia's family, were probably from Brest-Litovsk. Sylvia gave 1910 as the year she came, and her widowed mother, Rose, very probably followed in 1925, by way of Havana.

On Doris's side, both families came from southern Podolia, now in Vinnytsia province, Ukraine. The **Saslows**, her mother's family, were probably from Tulchin. Benjamin Saslow, a paperhanger, reached America in 1892, and his wife and two small daughters followed in 1893. The **Zaslows**, her father's family, came from Obodovka, about 42 km from Tulchin. Benjamin Zaslow probably arrived in Philadelphia in March 1904 with two of his brothers, and his parents followed to Brooklyn in 1906.

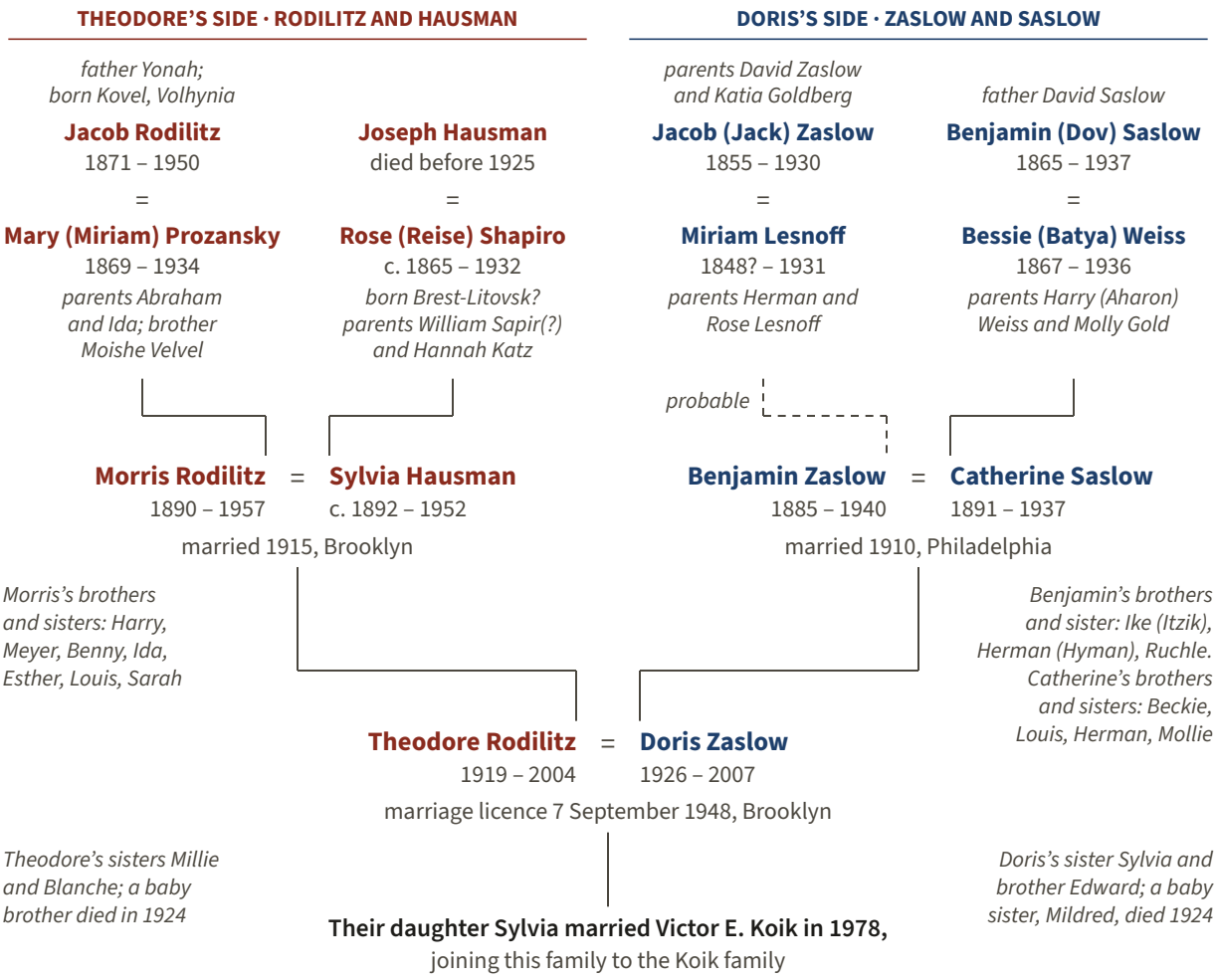
Spellings, names and dates

The family name appears as Rodilitz, Rodlitz, Rodolitz, Rodeletz, Rodelets, Rodelec and Rudales; Rodilitz is the form Theodore used and is used here. Zaslow appears as Zaslawer, Soslawer, Saslawer, Zaslof and Zosloff, and Saslow as Saslaw, Zaslaw and Sarlow.

Everyone in these families had a Yiddish or Hebrew name as well as the English one they used in America. The records show many of them: Morris was *Motel*, Harry *Hersch*, Meyer *Meier*, Benny *Berl*, Ida *Chaje*, Louis *Leib*, Sarah *Sure*; Bessie Saslow was *Basche* (Hebrew *Batya*) and Catherine was *Beile*; Benjamin Zaslow's Hebrew name was *Dov Ber*. Jacob Rodilitz was *Yaakov* and Mary was *Miriam Reizel*. These names are often the key to matching a European record with an American one.

Russia used the Julian (Old Style) calendar until 1918; it was 12 days behind the modern calendar in the 1800s and 13 days behind from

1900. Hebrew dates on gravestones follow the Jewish calendar. American records use the modern calendar.



Theodore Rodilitz and Doris Zaslow, their parents and grandparents. Red names: Theodore's side; blue: Doris's side. The dashed line marks a probable link: Benjamin Zaslow's parents are identified with about 80–85% confidence (part five). Dates followed by "?" are not yet confirmed from a record.

Names that look alike. *Zaslow* and *Saslow* are different families: Doris's father was Benjamin **Zaslow** and her mother was Catherine **Saslow**, daughter of another Benjamin, Benjamin **Saslow**. The names were spelled interchangeably by clerks, so each record has to be read with care. There are also three Sylvias: Theodore's mother, Sylvia Hausman; Doris's elder sister, Sylvia Zaslow (born 1911); and Theodore and Doris's own daughter.

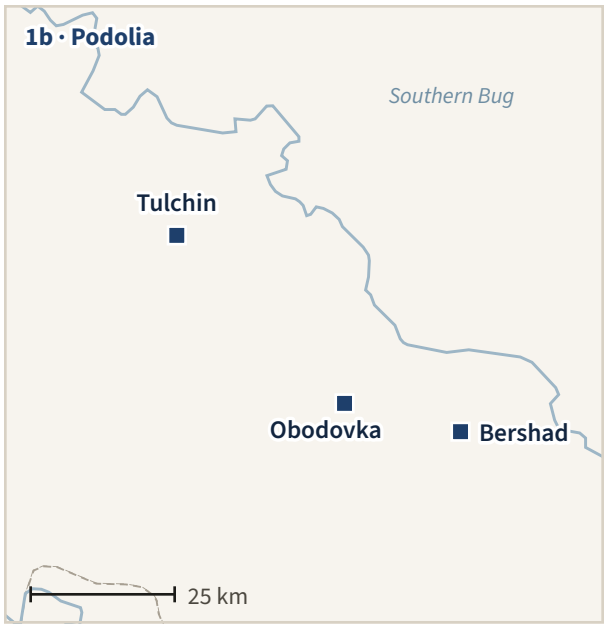
Map 1 · The home provinces

Grodno, Volhynia and Podolia

Where the four families lived before they emigrated, 1860s–1913







● Theodore's side: Rodilitz and Hausman places ■ Doris's side: Zaslow and Saslow places ● other towns, for orientation

Czerniany's position is approximate. Modern borders are shown; province names, for the Russian Empire before 1914, are placed approximately. Base map: Natural Earth.

Part one

The world they left

Every branch of this family came from the Pale of Settlement, the band of western provinces of the Russian Empire, from the Baltic to the Black Sea, where most Jews were required by law to live. In 1897 the Russian census counted about 4.9 million Jews in the Pale. They were about one in nine of its people, but most of them lived in towns and market towns (*shtetlekh*), where they were often the majority, and almost all of them spoke Yiddish.[1]

Grodno province, the Rodilitzes' home, lay in the north of the Pale. In 1897 its Kobrin district had 23,080 Jews and Brest district 45,902, and in the town of Kobrin itself Jews were about 69% of the population. Podolia, home of the Saslows and Zaslows, lay in the south. Tulchin had 10,055 Jews, 62% of the town; Obodovka, where Benjamin Zaslow was born, was much smaller, with about 1,675 Jews, a fifth of its people.[2]

The law hemmed these communities in. After the pogroms of 1881–82, the government's "Temporary Rules" of May 1882, known as the May Laws, barred Jews from settling anew in the countryside. In Kobrin a decree of the same year also stopped Jews from leasing farms and rural buildings. In 1897 the state took over the liquor trade, which had supported many Jewish families, and Kobrin's local history dates the start of heavy emigration, "especially to America," to that year. Brest burned in two great fires, in 1895 and 1901, and a Brest memorial book records "a great exodus from the city" after the second.[3]

Jacob Rodilitz was a Hebrew teacher (*melamed*), one of the commonest and worst-paid occupations in this world. A teacher usually ran a *heder*, a one-room religious school for small boys, often in his own home, and his family often needed other work to make ends meet.[4]

The home towns

Place in the records	Where it is	Before 1914	Family connection
Kobrin (Yiddish קאָבערין)	Kobryn, Brest region, Belarus	Kobrin district, Grodno province	Meyer, Benny and Sarah born here; Mary born "Kobryn"
Brest-Litovsk (Yiddish בריסק, Brisk)	Brest, Belarus	Brest district, Grodno province	Esther born here; probably Rose Hausman's birthplace

Place in the records	Where it is	Before 1914	Family connection
Czerniany	Charniany, Malaryta district, Belarus, about 27 km from Kobrin	Brest district, Grodno province	Morris's home in 1907; his mother lived there
Dwin	Divin (Dzivin), Kobryn district, Belarus, on the Kobrin–Kovel road	Kobrin district, Grodno province	Mary and the four youngest children, 1913
Kovel (Yiddish קאָווע֫ל)	Kovel, Volyn region, Ukraine	Kovel district, Volhynia	Jacob Rodilitz born here, 1871
Maczew, Maciow	Probably Maciejów, now Lukiv, 27 km west of Kovel	Kovel district, Volhynia	Jacob's and Harry's home in 1907 and 1910
Tulchin (Yiddish טולטשין)	Tulchyn, Vinnytsia region, Ukraine	Bratslav district, Podolia	The Saslows' burial society; probably their home
Obodofsky, Obodonka	Obodivka, Vinnytsia region, Ukraine, about 42 km from Tulchin	Olgopol district, Podolia	Benjamin Zaslow and his brother Herman born here
Podolsk, Podol	Podolia, the province	Podolia	Given by the Saslows in 1893 and the Zaslows in 1906

Identifications of Czerniany (medium-high confidence) and Maciejów (low to medium) are explained in parts two and three. "Grodno," given as a birthplace on several American records, probably means the province rather than the city.

Why they left, and when

No record found so far gives any of these emigrants' own reasons for leaving, so what follows is general history, set against the dates on which each of them left. Historians used to explain the great Jewish emigration chiefly by pogroms. More recent work, especially by Gur Alroey, gives more weight to poverty, to letters from relatives already abroad, and to the spread of information about the journey.[5]

The **Saslows** left in 1892–93. In 1891 about 30,000 Jews were expelled from Moscow into the already crowded Pale, and in 1892 cholera spread across the empire and reached Hamburg. Jewish immigration from Russia to the United States reached 76,417 in 1892, the highest figure before 1900.[6]

Benjamin Zaslow left in March 1904, aged 19, just after Japan attacked Port Arthur and the Russo-Japanese War began. Young men were called up in the year they turned 21, so his own call-up would have come in 1906; the wartime pressure of 1904–05 fell first on reservists, men who had already served. Jewish immigration from

Russia rose from 47,689 in 1903 to 77,544 in 1904.[7] Whether the war or the draft had anything to do with his leaving is unknown.

The **Rodilitzes** left between 1907 and 1913, when emigration had become routine, carried by letters home and tickets bought in America and sent back to Europe. No pogrom has been found in Kobrin between 1881 and 1914, nor in Tulchin or Obodovka in 1903–06. Brest saw violence in 1905, and Białystok, in the same province, a pogrom in 1906 in which about 80 Jews were killed. Tulchin and Obodovka suffered their worst pogroms later, in 1919.[8]

The journey

To leave legally, a Russian subject needed a foreign passport, which was slow and costly to obtain. Perhaps three quarters of Jewish emigrants crossed the border without one, with the help of agents and smugglers. From 1893–94 the German shipping lines ran control stations along the Prussian border, where emigrants bound for Hamburg and Bremen were bathed, examined for disease, and checked for money and a ticket. Alroey puts the full cost of getting one adult from the Pale to America at about 165–215 roubles, at a time when a working family earned perhaps 500–600 roubles a year. That is why families so often went one or two at a time.[9]

The family used every main route. Morris sailed from Bremen; Harry, and later Mary with the youngest children, from Hamburg; Jacob, Meyer and Benny with the Holland-America Line from Rotterdam. The Saslows went the “indirect” way, from Hamburg to Britain and on from Glasgow, and the Zaslows from Liverpool. Steerage passengers landing at New York went through Ellis Island, opened in 1892, where officers checked them against the ship’s list and could hold anyone “likely to become a public charge.” Philadelphia’s arrivals landed at the Washington Avenue station on Pier 53.[10]

Part two

The Rodilitzes of Kobrin district

Jacob and Mary

Jacob Rodilitz (Yiddish *Jankel*; in his own papers *Rodeletz*) was born on 15 March 1871 in Kovel, Volhynia. When he applied to become an American citizen he described himself as a Hebrew teacher.[11] His wife **Mary**, called Miriam and Mariam in the records, was born on 25 December 1869. Her maiden name is written Prozansky, Pruzansky and Porojinsky, and her parents were Abraham and Ida; the 1913 passenger list gives her birthplace as Kobryn.[12] Their gravestone gives the next generation back: Jacob was **Yaakov son of Yonah**, and Mary was **Miriam Reizel daughter of Avraham**.[44]

Jacob's 1927 naturalization petition names their eight children with their dates of birth. Their birthplaces come from their own later records:

Child	Yiddish name	Born	Birthplace as recorded
Morris	Motel	17 April 1890	Czerniany; "Grodno"
Harry	Hersch	20 August 1892	Maczew
Meyer	Meier	5 March 1894	Kobrin
Benny (Benjamin)	Berl	28 April 1896	Kobrin
Ida	Chaje	19 January 1898	"Grodno"; Kobryn
Esther	Ester	4 March 1900	Brest; Kobryn
Louis	Leib	14 August 1905	"Grodno"; Kobryn
Sarah	Sure	6 February 1907	Kobrin

Some of these dates disagree with ages on other records: Esther's age on her 1913 passenger list points to about 1903, and Ida's and Esther's marriage certificates make them younger than the petition does.

The family seems to have lived in or moved between two areas about 80–115 km apart. Jacob in 1907 and Harry in 1910 gave their home as *Maczew* or *Maciow*, probably Maciejów (now Lukiv), a small town 27 km west of Kovel. Everyone else gave places in the Kobrin–Brest area of Grodno province: Czerniany, Kobrin, Brest and Divin. Divin stands on the road from Kobrin to Kovel, roughly between the two areas (map 1a).

Mary's other names. Two sons' passenger lists give their mother as *Resel* (Harry, 1910) and *R.* (Meyer, 1911), and Ida's and Esther's marriage certificates give her maiden name as *Rosen*. Her gravestone explains the first two: her full name was **Miriam Reizel**, and Reizel (Rose) was the name the family used, for the plot her children later bought is named for "Jacob & Miriam Rose." *Rosen* on the marriage certificates is probably a clerk's mishearing of the same name.

One at a time: the crossings, 1907–1913

Jacob went first. The Holland-America Line's register of passage money records "Jankel Rudoles" sailing from Rotterdam on the *Rijndam* on 27 April 1907, and the ship reached New York on 7 May; Jacob later swore that he arrived on 9 May 1907 on the *Ryndam*. The Ellis Island list for that voyage has a "Jankel Rudales," 33, married, from *Mariow* or *Maciow*, whose passage was paid by his brother-in-law, going to that brother-in-law, "B. Rozankrans," at 70 Orchard Street on Manhattan's Lower East Side. The ship, the date and his home town fit Jacob; his age (33 rather than 36), his occupation ("miller," perhaps a misreading of *melamed*) and his height do not, so this line is probably, but not certainly, his (about 70%). B. Rozankrans has not been identified: he was not living at 70 Orchard Street in 1905 or 1910.[13]

The sons followed, one by one, each going to their father in Brooklyn:

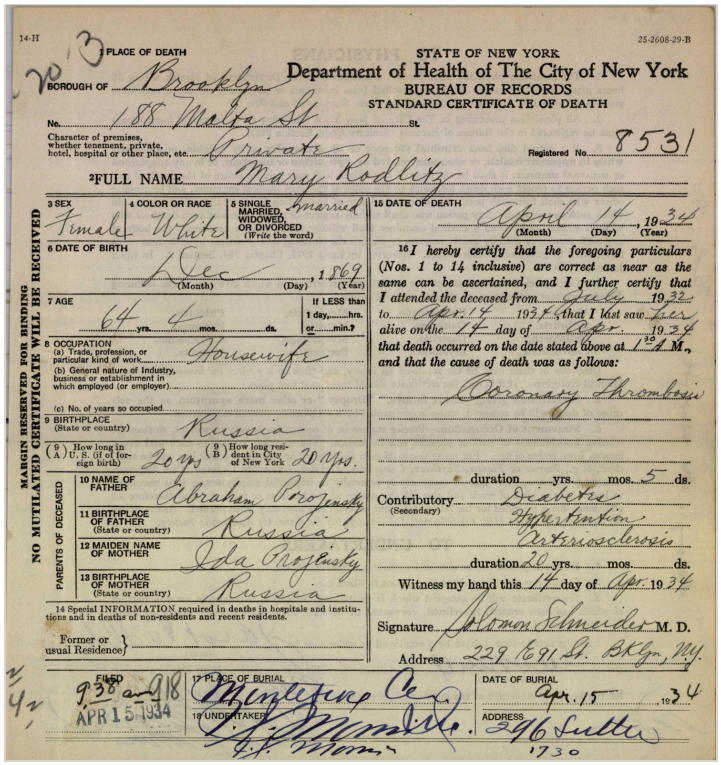
Who	Ship and port	Arrived	Details from the passenger list
Morris (Motel), 18	*Breslau*, from Bremen	16 December 1907	From Czerniany; mother Mariem there; passage paid by his father; $2; to father Jankel, 326 Snediker Ave
Harry (Hersch), 18	*Cleveland*, from Hamburg	12 June 1910	Locksmith, from Maczew; mother "Resel"; to his father at 326 Snediker Ave
Meyer (Meier), 18	*Rotterdam*, from Rotterdam (sailed 22 July)	31 July 1911	From Kobrin; passage paid by his father; to father at 721 Vienna Ave
Benny (Berl), 17	*Potsdam*, from Rotterdam (sailed 22 June)	2–3 July 1912	From Kobrin; mother Marya; passage paid by his father; held as a possible public charge ("underdeveloped for 17"); admitted 5 July
Mary, 47, with Chaje (Ida) 16, Ester 10, Leib (Louis) 9 and Sure (Sarah) 7	*Pretoria*, from Hamburg	22 December 1913	From Dwin (Divin); all born Kobryn; an uncle, Joel M., left behind in Dwin; to her husband at 721 Vienna Ave

The Holland-America registers show that Jacob's, Meyer's and Benny's tickets were all booked through the line's own office in New York and entered as prepaid, and Meyer's and Benny's passenger lists say their passage was paid by their father. So Jacob bought his sons' tickets in America and sent them to Europe. His own ticket, too, was bought in New York, apparently by the brother-in-law he went to join.[14] Mary stayed in Europe with the four youngest for six and a half years, a long separation but not an unusual one; by 1913 they were living in Divin. She arrived eight months before the First World War closed the routes.

Brooklyn

The family settled in East New York, Brooklyn, beside Brownsville, where garment work and new transit lines had drawn tens of thousands of Jewish families out of the Lower East Side. Their addresses follow the family's growth: 326 Snediker Avenue (1907–10), 721 Vienna Avenue (1911–13), 115 Malta Street (1915), and from about 1919 **188 Malta Street**, which stayed the family home into the 1930s. In June 1915, eighteen months after Mary's arrival, the New York state census found all ten together at 115 Malta Street.[15]

Six of the other children's marriages have been found, and all six gave 188 Malta Street as their home: Harry married Fannie Bunder in 1919, Ida married Irving Hovelin and Esther Sol Feinberg in 1927, Sarah married Martin Gordon in 1929, Meyer married Henrietta Frankel in 1932, and Louis married Gertrude Kaplan in 1934. Every wedding but Meyer's was held at, or by the rabbi of, the synagogue at 41 Malta Street, where Morris had married in 1915. Meyer was in Europe at the end of the First World War; he returned to New York in November 1919, giving his father at 188 Malta Street as his nearest relative.[16]



STATE OF NEW YORK
Department of Health of The City of New York
BUREAU OF RECORDS
STANDARD CERTIFICATE OF DEATH

PLACE OF DEATH — BOROUGH OF Brooklyn — No. 188 Malta St — Character of premises, whether tenement, private, hotel, hospital or other place, etc. Private — Registered No. 8531

2 FULL NAME Mary Rodlitz

3 SEX Female — 4 COLOR OR RACE White — 5 SINGLE, MARRIED, WIDOWED OR DIVORCED (If Yrite the word) Married

6 DATE OF BIRTH Dec. 1869 (Month) (Day) (Year)

7 AGE 64 yrs. 4 mos. ds. — If LESS than 1 day, hrs. or min.?

8 OCCUPATION (a) Trade, profession, or particular kind of work Housewife (b) General nature of Industry, business or establishment in which employed (or employer) (c) No. of years so occupied

9 BIRTHPLACE (State or country) Russia — (g) How long in U. S. (if of foreign birth) 20 yrs. — (g) How long resident in City of New York 20 yrs.

PARENTS OF DECEASED
10 NAME OF FATHER Abraham Porojinsky
11 BIRTHPLACE OF FATHER (State or country) Russia
12 MAIDEN NAME OF MOTHER Ida Porojinsky
13 BIRTHPLACE OF MOTHER (State or country) Russia

14 Special INFORMATION required in deaths in hospitals and institutions and in deaths of non-residents and recent residents.

Former or usual Residence

15 DATE OF DEATH April 14 (Month) (Day) 1934 (Year)

16 I hereby certify that the foregoing particulars (Nos. 1 to 14 inclusive) are correct as near as the same can be ascertained, and I further certify that I attended the deceased from July 1932 to Apr. 14 1934, that I last saw her alive on the 14 day of Apr. 1934, that death occurred on the date stated above at 12 M., and that the cause of death was as follows:

Coronary Thrombosis
duration yrs. mos. 5 ds.
Contributory (Secondary) Diabetes
Hypertension
Arteriosclerosis
duration 20 yrs. mos. ds.

Witness my hand this 17 day of Apr. 1934
Signature Solomon Schneider M. D.
Address 229 E 91 St. BKlyn, NY.

FILED APR 15 1934 — 17 PLACE OF BURIAL Montefiore Cem. — DATE OF BURIAL Apr. 15 1934 — 18 UNDERTAKER D. Mamikle. — ADDRESS 396 Sutter 1730

MARGIN RESERVED FOR BINDING NO MUTILATED CERTIFICATE WILL BE RECEIVED

Mary Rodlitz's death certificate, Brooklyn, 14 April 1934. It names her parents as Abraham Porojinsky and Ida Projinsky, and records twenty years in the United States. NYC Municipal Archives, D-K-1934-0008531.

Jacob declared his intention to become a citizen in 1924 and was naturalized in February 1929. **Mary died at 188 Malta Street on 14 April 1934**, aged 64, and was buried the next day at Montefiore Cemetery in Queens. Her death certificate gives her parents as Abraham Porojinsky and Ida Projinsky and her time in America as twenty years.[12] **Jacob died on 14 or 15 June 1950**, aged 79 by his papers (82 on his stone), and was buried beside her, in the plot of the Agudath Achim Anshe New Lots congregation, a local synagogue of East New York.[45]

Yonah and Avraham

The Hebrew inscriptions on Jacob and Mary's shared stone, headed RODELETZ and "Beloved Mother and Father," are the oldest family names yet found on this side:

Stone	Hebrew inscription	Translation	Died
Jacob	יעקב בן ר' יונה	Yaakov son of R. Yonah	1st day of Rosh Chodesh Tammuz 5710 (15 June 1950)
Mary	מרים רייזל בת ר' אברהם	Miriam Reizel daughter of R. Avraham	29 Nisan 5694 (14 April 1934)

So **Jacob's father was Yonah** (Jonah), and Mary's father Abraham, named on her death certificate, is confirmed. A grandson confirms both. Harry's first son, born on 21 May 1920, was **Abraham Jonas Rodolitz**; his own stone reads *Avraham Yonah son of R. Tzvi Hersh*. He was named after both of Harry's grandfathers. Ashkenazi Jews name children only after relatives who have died, so both Abraham Prozansky and Yonah Rodilitz had probably died, in Europe, by 1920.[46]

Mary's brother, Moishe Velvel

In August 1909 an 18-year-old shoemaker named **Moische Wolf Prozanski** landed at Ellis Island from Antwerp on the *Kroonland*. He came from "Du…," almost certainly Divin, and the relative he left behind was his **"sister Marina Rodelitz," of Divin**. This is Mary, four years before she left, and it confirms both her maiden name and her home in Divin.[47]

He settled in Chicago, where he used the name **Morris William Rosen**. He enlisted in the US Army at Jefferson Barracks, Missouri, in October 1915, served in the Quartermaster Corps until a medical discharge in April 1918, and was naturalized in Chicago in December 1921 as "Moishe Velval (Morris William) Prozansky (Rosen)," born 5 March 1892. In 1928 he entered the veterans' home at Sawtelle, Los Angeles; asked for his nearest relative, he gave **"Sister, Mary Rodeletz, address unknown, New York."** He stayed in Los Angeles, working in the clothing trade, and probably died there in March 1982, aged 89; he is buried at Young Israel Cemetery, Norwalk, under a stone reading "Morris W. Rosen 1892–1982." No wife or children have been found.[47]

Moishe Velvel was 22 years younger than Mary. He may have been a late child of Abraham and Ida, or a half-brother from a second marriage of Abraham's; the records do not yet say. His veteran's file, which the Department of Veterans Affairs still holds, should name his parents.

Part three

Morris, Sylvia and the Hausmans

Morris

Morris Rodilitz, the eldest son, was born *Motel* on 17 April 1890. He was the second of the family to cross, landing at Ellis Island from the *Breslau* on 16 December 1907, seven months after his father. The list describes an 18-year-old who could read and write, from **Czerniany** in Grodno province, where his mother still lived; his father had paid his passage, and he arrived with $2.[17]

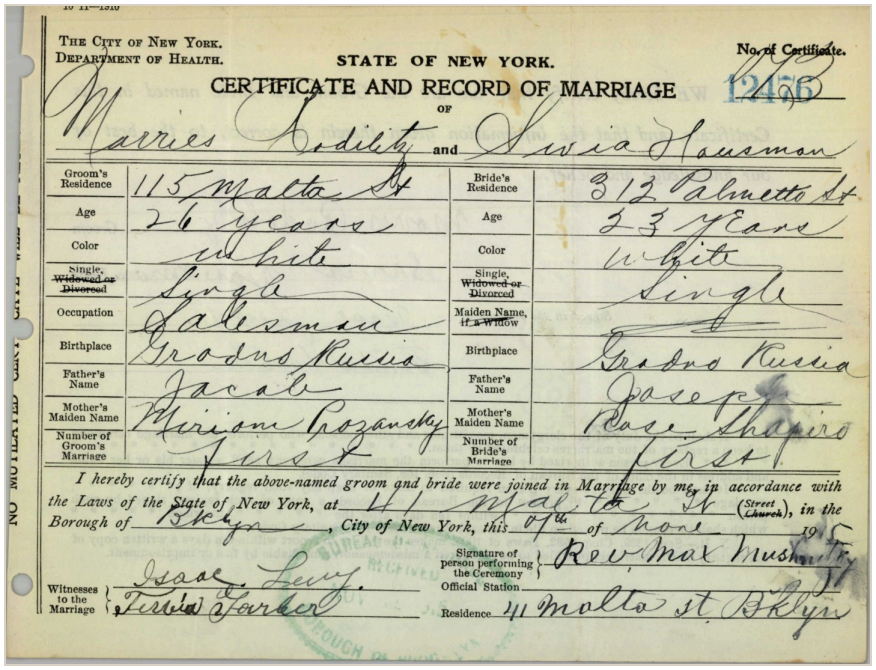
Czerniany is probably the village of Chernyany (Charniany), now in Malaryta district of Belarus's Brest region. Before 1914 it was in Brest district of Grodno province, about 27 km south-south-west of Kobrin and 35 km from Brest. It was a village with a handful of Jewish families, about a hundred people before 1941, not a market town.[18]

Morris declared his intention to become a citizen on 15 November 1913, the same day as his brother Harry, and was naturalized in Brooklyn in 1921. Both brothers gave their birthplace only as "Grodno, Russia"; their certificates of arrival confirm the 1907 and 1910 passenger lists. He worked as a salesman in 1915, in the "novelty" trade in 1930, and as a stock clerk in 1940.[19]

Morris and Sylvia

On 7 November 1915 Morris married **Sivia (Sylvia) Hausman** at 41 Malta Street, on the same street as his family's home at 115 Malta Street. She was 23, living at 312 Palmetto Street, and, like Morris, gave her birthplace as Grodno, Russia. Her parents were Joseph Hausman and Rose Shapiro.[20]

Sylvia later gave 1910 as the year she came to America. Her crossing has not been found, despite searches under many spellings; she may have travelled under a different name, or, like her mother and sister later, by way of Cuba.[21]



THE CITY OF NEW YORK.
DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH.

STATE OF NEW YORK.

No. of Certificate. 12476

CERTIFICATE AND RECORD OF MARRIAGE

OF

Morris Rodilitz and Sivia Hausman

	Groom		Bride
Residence	115 Malta St	Residence	312 Palmetto St
Age	26 years	Age	23 years
Color	white	Color	white
Single, ~~Widowed or Divorced~~	Single	Single, ~~Widowed or Divorced~~	Single
Occupation	Salesman	Maiden Name, ~~if a Widow~~	
Birthplace	Grodno Russia	Birthplace	Grodno Russia
Father's Name	Jacob	Father's Name	Joseph
Mother's Maiden Name	Miriam Prozansky	Mother's Maiden Name	Rose Shapiro
Number of Groom's Marriage	First	Number of Bride's Marriage	First

I hereby certify that the above-named groom and bride were joined in Marriage by me, in accordance with the Laws of the State of New York, at 41 Malta St (Street, Church), in the Borough of Bklyn, City of New York, this 07th of Nov 1915

Witnesses to the Marriage: Isaac Levy. Fevia Farber

Signature of person performing the Ceremony: Rev. Max Mush...

Official Station

Residence 41 Malta st Bklyn

NO DUPLICATE CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED

Certificate and record of marriage, Brooklyn, 7 November 1915. Morris Rodilitz, 26, salesman, born Grodno, son of Jacob and Miriam Prozansky, married Sivia Hausman, 23, born Grodno, daughter of Joseph and Rose Shapiro, at 41 Malta Street. Witnesses Isaac Levy and Fevia(?) Farber. NYC Municipal Archives, M-K-1915-0012476.

Morris and Sylvia's first years were spent with his family: in 1920 they and their two children were a second household at 188 Malta Street. By 1925 they had their own home at **537 Georgia Avenue**, where they were still living in 1940. They had four children:

- **Millie (Mildred)**, born about 1917;
- **Theodore**, born on 25 April 1919 in Brooklyn;
- a son, born on 6 August 1924, who lived four days and was buried at Mount Lebanon Cemetery;
- **Blanche**, born about 1927.[22]

Sylvia died on 14 December 1952, and **Morris on 6 January 1957**, aged 66. They are buried at New Montefiore Cemetery, West Babylon, Long Island, in a family plot that Jacob and Mary's children named for their parents: the **"Jacob & Miriam Rose Rodolitz" family circle**. Morris's brothers Meyer (1950), Harry (1967) and Louis (1970) lie there too.[48]

Rose Hausman, by way of Havana

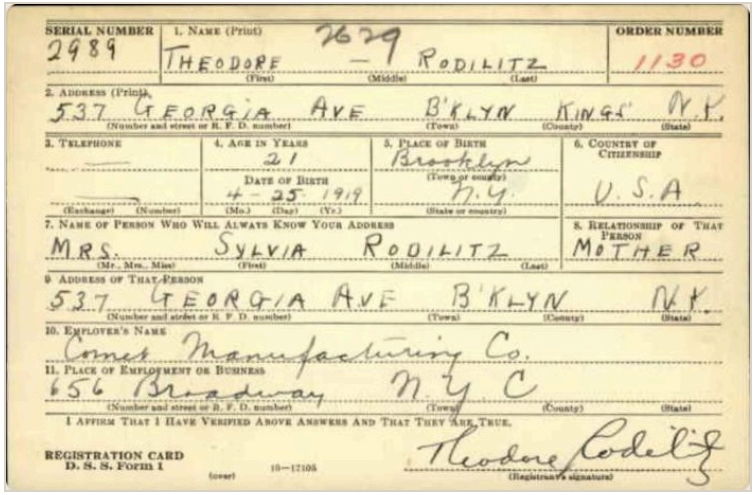
Sylvia's mother was very probably the **Rose (Reise, Rejza) Hausman** who came to New York on 12 May 1925 aboard the *Ebro* from Havana; her name, age, widowhood and timing all fit. The list calls her a widow of 60, born at *Brassc*, which is probably Brześć, the Polish

name for Brest-Litovsk. She left a daughter, **Fega**, in Havana, at San Ignacio 57, and was going to another daughter, **G. Weisberg**, at 636 East 135th Street in the Bronx. Officers held her for two days as "likely to become a public charge," a rule used especially against elderly widows. Three weeks later the state census found her in Morris and Sylvia's home at 537 Georgia Avenue.[23]

Rose's route was typical of its time. The quota laws of 1921 and 1924 sharply limited immigration from eastern Europe, and Cuba became a waystation for Jews hoping to reach the United States. How Rose qualified to enter is a question for her immigration file. Her husband **Joseph Hausman** had died before 1925, probably in Europe or Cuba. Rose died in the Bronx on 15 November 1932, aged 67; her death certificate names her parents as William Sapir(?) and Hannah Katz, Sapir being a form of Shapiro.[23]

Theodore

Theodore Rodilitz was born in Brooklyn on 25 April 1919 and grew up at 537 Georgia Avenue. In 1940 he was single, living with his parents and working as an assistant manager. When he registered for the draft that autumn, aged 21, he worked for the Comet Manufacturing Company at 656 Broadway, Manhattan, and named his mother, Mrs. Sylvia Rodilitz, as the person who would always know his address.[24] He enlisted in the Army in April 1941 and was a soldier when, in September 1943, he married for the first time, at the Twin Cantors Temple on Eastern Parkway; that marriage was annulled in December 1946.[49]

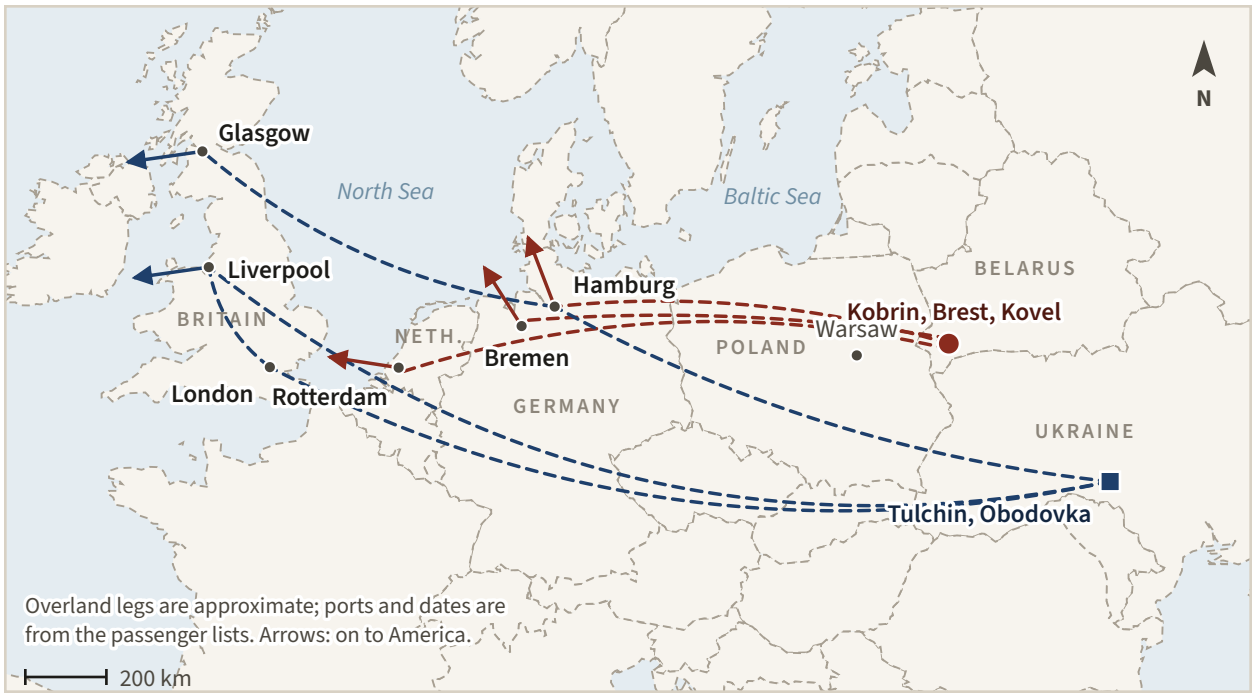

SERIAL NUMBER 2989 · 1. NAME (Print) THEODORE 2629 RODILITZ (First Middle Last) · ORDER NUMBER 1130
2. ADDRESS (Print) 537 GEORGIA AVE (Number and street or R. F. D. number) B'KLYN (Town) KINGS (County) N.Y. (State)
3. TELEPHONE (Exchange) (Number) · 4. AGE IN YEARS 21 · DATE OF BIRTH 4 - 25 1919 (Mo.) (Day) (Yr.) · 5. PLACE OF BIRTH Brooklyn (Town or county) N.Y. (State or country) · 6. COUNTRY OF CITIZENSHIP U.S.A
7. NAME OF PERSON WHO WILL ALWAYS KNOW YOUR ADDRESS MRS. SYLVIA RODILITZ (Mr., Mrs., Miss) (First) (Middle) (Last) · 8. RELATIONSHIP OF THAT PERSON MOTHER
9. ADDRESS OF THAT PERSON 537 GEORGIA AVE (Number and street or R. F. D. number) B'KLYN (Town) (County) N.Y. (State)
10. EMPLOYER'S NAME Comet Manufacturing Co.
11. PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS 656 Broadway (Number and street or R. F. D. number) N Y C (Town) (County) (State)
I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE. Theodore Rodilitz (Registrant's signature)
REGISTRATION CARD D. S. S. Form 1 (over) 10—17105

Theodore Rodilitz's draft registration card, Brooklyn, 1940. Serial number 2989, order number 1130. 537 Georgia Avenue; born 25 April 1919, Brooklyn; employer Comet Manufacturing Co. From the family's Ancestry account.

Map 2 · The crossings

From the home towns to the ports, 1892–1925

Each family member's route to America, as far as the passenger lists show it. Circles: Theodore's side; squares: Doris's side; dashed overland legs are approximate.



Year	Who	From	Ship	To
1892	Benjamin Saslow	Podolia	not found	America; living in Philadelphia by 1900
1893	Bessie Saslow, Beckie and Catherine	Hamburg, 16 June; Glasgow	*Circassia*	Ellis Island, 3 July
1904	Benjamin Zaslow, probably with brothers Itzik and David	London; Liverpool, 2 March	*Haverford* (probable)	Philadelphia, 14 March
1906	Jacob and Miriam Zaslawer, with Ruchle	Liverpool	*Umbria*	Ellis Island, 6 August
1907	Jacob Rodilitz	Rotterdam, 27 April	*Rijndam*	Ellis Island, 7–9 May
1907	Morris Rodilitz	Bremen	*Breslau*	Ellis Island, 16 December
1910	Harry Rodilitz	Hamburg	*Cleveland*	Ellis Island, 12 June
1910	Sylvia Hausman	not found	not found	New York (year from censuses)
1911	Meyer Rodilitz	Rotterdam, 22 July	*Rotterdam*	Ellis Island, 31 July
1912	Benny Rodilitz	Rotterdam, 22 June	*Potsdam*	Ellis Island, 2–3 July
1913	Mary Rodilitz with Ida, Esther, Louis and Sarah	Hamburg	*Pretoria*	Ellis Island, 22 December
1925	Rose Hausman	Havana	*Ebro*	Ellis Island, 12 May

Part four

The Saslows of Podolia

Benjamin and Bessie

Doris Zaslow's mother, Catherine, was the daughter of **Benjamin Saslow**, whose Hebrew name, on his gravestone, was *Dov son of David*. He was born in June 1865 and reached America in 1892, the year he always gave to census takers; his ship has not been found. He was a paperhanger. In 1900 he could read, write and speak English, but when he was naturalized on 15 December 1902 he signed his petition with his mark.[25]

His wife, **Bessie** (*Basche*; Hebrew *Batya*), was born in March 1867. Her parents were Harry (Hebrew *Aharon*) Weiss and Molly Gold. In 1900 she could not yet read, write or speak English; the next year's city directory lists her as a grocer, at the same address as her husband.[26]

The crossing of 1893

Bessie followed her husband a year later with their two small daughters. A Hamburg emigration list records **Basche Zaslaw**, 26, with **Jety**, 3, and **Beile**, 1, leaving Hamburg on 16 June 1893, from "Podolsk" and bound for Philadelphia. They crossed from Glasgow on the Anchor Line's *Circassia* and landed at Ellis Island on 3 July 1893.[27]



The *Circassia* list, 3 July 1893 (detail). "Basche Zaslaw, 26, wife," from "Padolsk," bound for Philadelphia, with Leib, 30, printer, Jety, 2, and Beile, 1. Statue of Liberty–Ellis Island Foundation; NARA M237. The whole page is on the cover.

The match is strong, about 90%. Catherine's Hebrew name on her gravestone is *Beila*, and her mother's is *Batya*, matching Beile and Basche; Beckie's and Catherine's birth dates in the 1900 census, December 1889 and April 1891, fit Jety's and Beile's ages. The man travelling with them, **Leib Zaslaw**, 30, a printer who could read and write, was probably not Bessie's husband, who was Dov, a paperhanger who signed with a mark, and who named a son Leib in 1895, which Jewish custom avoided for a living father. Leib was probably a relative escorting the family.[27]

The route is unusual and has a likely explanation. That same month, June 1893, Hamburg banned Russian steerage passengers from embarking because of fears of cholera, and many emigrants went instead by the "indirect" route across the North Sea to Britain and on to America from Liverpool or Glasgow. The records do not say why the family went by Glasgow; the ban is a reasonable inference.[28]

Philadelphia

The Saslows lived in South Philadelphia, the city's main Jewish quarter: at 787 South Third Street in 1900, at 1924 South Fifth Street in 1910, and by 1920 in their own house at **2208 South Fifth Street**. Benjamin had his own paperhanging business. Five children lived to adulthood:

- **Beckie** (Jety), born in December 1889 in Russia, who married David Mitchell and died on 26 August 1914, aged 25;
- **Catherine** (Beile, Katie), born in April 1891 in Russia: Doris's mother;
- **Louis**, born in Philadelphia in 1893 or 1895;
- **Herman**, born in November 1896;
- **Mollie**, born in April 1899.[29]

Bessie died on 8 May 1936 at her daughter Catherine's house, 2163 East Cambria Street, and Benjamin on 19 July 1937, aged 72 (his gravestone says 73). They are buried at **Har Jehuda Cemetery** in Upper Darby, outside Philadelphia. Benjamin lies in section D in the plot of a **Tulchiner** society, a burial society of people from Tulchin, and Catherine, who died seven weeks after him, in the next grave.[30]

Why Tulchin. No record yet names the Saslows' home town. The burial plot is the best clue: Jewish immigrants were usually buried with their *landslayt*, people from the same town, in plots bought by a society named for it (a *landsmanshaft*). The society that owns the plot was probably Philadelphia's Tulchiner Beneficial Association, into which two other societies later merged, so the plot supports a Tulchin origin without proving it.[31] One possible trace has been found in Tulchin's own registers: in March 1880 a boy of seven, **Avrum Zaslav, son of Duvid**, died there. Benjamin's father was David, so the boy may have been Benjamin's younger brother, but David was a common name and this is only a lead.[50]

Part five

The Zaslows of Obodovka

Benjamin Zaslow's own account

Benjamin Zaslow, Doris's father, was born on 8 January 1885 at "Obodofsky," Russia, by his own account in his naturalization papers. This was Obodovka (Obodivka), a small Jewish market town in Olgopol district, Podolia. In 1921 he swore that he had come from Liverpool on a ship he called the *Rappaport*, landing at Philadelphia on or about 15 March 1904, and in 1923 that he had left England about 6 March. No ship of that name sailed to Philadelphia; it may have been the name of a ticket agent.[32]

The *Haverford*, March 1904

Only one ship from Liverpool reached Philadelphia that week: the American Line's *Haverford*, which sailed on 2 March and docked on 14 March 1904. Its passenger list has no one named Zaslow, but it does have three brothers named **Saslawer**: **Itzik**, 29, married, a painter; **Berl**, 22, single, a painter; and **David**, 19, single, a tailor. Their last residence was London, where they had spent three months; before that, a place that probably reads *Obodiwka*. They had paid their own passage and were going to a friend, S. Weisberg, at 391 Amsterdam Avenue in New York.[33]

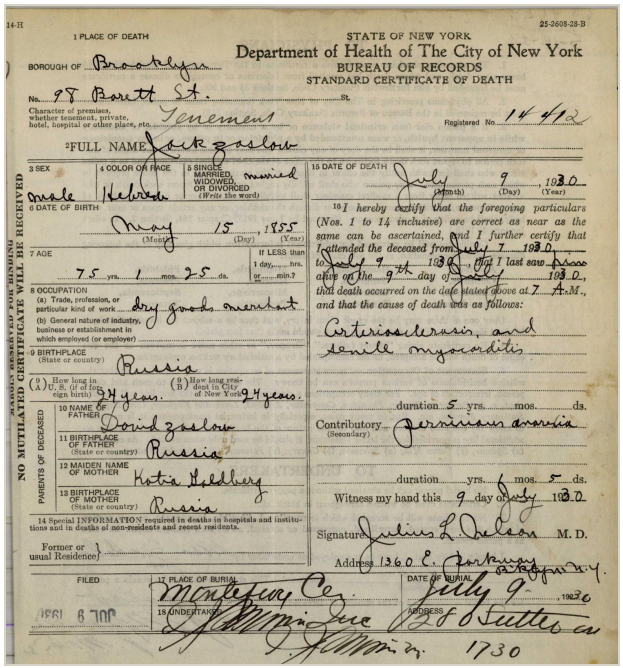
The brothers' family has probably been found in Brooklyn. On 6 August 1906 **Jankel** and **Marjem Soslawer**, 54 and 52, with **Ruchle**, 17, landed at Ellis Island from Liverpool on the *Umbria*, from "Podol." Their passage had been paid by their son, and they were going to him, care of H. Lesnoff, at 207 Hopkins Street, Brooklyn. In the 1910 census the same couple, now **Jacob and Mary Zaslawer**, were living on Chester Street, Brooklyn, with two sons who had come in 1904: **Benjamin**, 26, single, a pants-factory operator, and **Hyman**, 24.[34]

> **The case that Benjamin Zaslow was "Berl Saslawer"** (probable, about 80–85%)
>
> - **For:** His gravestone gives his Hebrew name as **Dov Ber**, the name behind the Yiddish **Berl**.
> - **For:** His death certificate names his parents as **Jacob and Miriam**, the names of the Brooklyn couple.
> - **For:** The Brooklyn household had a son **Benjamin**, born about 1884, single, who came in 1904. Benjamin Zaslow married in Philadelphia in 1910, after the census, and the Philadelphia directories of 1899–1910 have no Benjamin Zaslow before then.

- **For: Obodovka** links them: Benjamin's brother **Herman** (Hyman) gave his birthplace as "Obodonka" on his 1942 draft card, and the brothers' 1904 list probably reads **Obodiwka**.
- **For:** The **Haverford** is the only Liverpool ship that fits Benjamin's sworn date.
- **Against:** Berl's age, 22, implies a birth about 1882, not 1885; the brothers were bound for New York, not Philadelphia; Benjamin remembered 6 March, not 2 March; and no single document yet joins the Brooklyn Benjamin to the Philadelphia one.
- **Against:** His gravestone names his father as **Yochanan**, not Yaakov (Jacob); a possible explanation is given below. The 1910 marriage licence, which names the groom's parents, should settle the question.

Jacob and Miriam in Brooklyn

Benjamin's father, **Jacob Zaslow**, known in America as **Jack**, was born on 15 May 1855 and died on 9 July 1930 at 98 Barrett Street, Brooklyn, a dry goods merchant who had been in the United States 24 years, which fits his 1906 arrival. His death certificate takes the family back another generation: his parents were **David Zaslow** and **Katia Goldberg**.[35]


STATE OF NEW YORK
Department of Health of The City of New York
BUREAU OF RECORDS
STANDARD CERTIFICATE OF DEATH

1 PLACE OF DEATH — BOROUGH OF Brooklyn — No. 98 Barett St. — Character of premises, whether tenement, private, hotel, hospital or other place, etc. Tenement — Registered No. 14 412

2 FULL NAME Jack Zaslow

3 SEX: Male — 4 COLOR OR RACE: Hebrew — 5 SINGLE, MARRIED, WIDOWED, OR DIVORCED (Write the word): married

6 DATE OF BIRTH: May (Month) 15 (Day) 1855 (Year)

7 AGE: 75 yrs. 1 mos. 25 ds. — If LESS than 1 day, hrs. or min.?

8 OCCUPATION: (a) Trade, profession, or particular kind of work: dry goods merchant — (b) General nature of industry, business or establishment in which employed (or employer):

9 BIRTHPLACE (State or country): Russia — (a) How long in U. S. (if of foreign birth): 24 years. — (b) How long resident in City of New York: 24 years.

10 NAME OF FATHER: David Zaslow

11 BIRTHPLACE OF FATHER (State or country): Russia

12 MAIDEN NAME OF MOTHER: Katia Goldberg

13 BIRTHPLACE OF MOTHER (State or country): Russia

14 Special INFORMATION required in deaths in hospitals and institutions and in deaths of non-residents and recent residents.

Former or usual Residence:

15 DATE OF DEATH: July (Month) 9 (Day) 1930 (Year)

16 I hereby certify that the foregoing particulars (Nos. 1 to 14 inclusive) are correct as near as the same can be ascertained, and I further certify that I attended the deceased from July 7 1930 to July 9 1930, that I last saw alive on the 9 day of July 1930, that death occurred on the date stated above at 7 A.M., and that the causes of death were as follows:

Arteriosclerosis, and senile myocarditis

duration 5 yrs. mos. ds.

Contributory (Secondary): pernicious anemia

duration yrs. 6 mos. 5 ds.

Witness my hand this 9 day of July 1930

Signature: Julius L. Nelson M. D.

Address: 1360 E. 5th [illegible] N.Y.

FILED — 17 PLACE OF BURIAL: Montefiore Cem. — DATE OF BURIAL: July 9, 1930 — 18 UNDERTAKER: [illegible] — ADDRESS: [illegible] Sutter Av

1730

NO MUTILATED CERTIFICATE WILL BE RECEIVED — PARENTS OF DECEASED

Jack Zaslow's death certificate, Brooklyn, 9 July 1930. Born 15 May 1855 in Russia; dry goods merchant; 24 years in the United States; father David Zaslow, mother Katia Goldberg; buried at Montefiore. NYC Municipal Archives, D-K-1930-0014412.

Benjamin's mother, **Miriam (Marjem, Mary) née Lesnoff**, daughter of Herman and Rose Lesnoff, died in Brooklyn on 14 September 1931 after a fall. Jack and Miriam are buried side by side at Montefiore Cemetery, in graves 25 and 26 of the plot of the Adath Israel society of

Brownsville and East New York. The "H. Lesnoff" the parents went to in 1906 was probably **Harry Lesnoff**, a painter who came in 1904 and lived near them in 1910, perhaps Miriam's brother or nephew.[36]

Of the brothers, **Itzik** became **Ike Zaslow**, a presser of cloaks in Brooklyn; his death certificate in 1940 names his parents as Jacob Zaslow and Miriam Lesnov, and he is buried at Montefiore in the plot of the Bershider society, from Bershad, about 20 km from Obodovka, which he had helped to found in 1922. **Herman** (Hyman), born on 15 September 1886, died in New York in 1958. **David** Saslawer has not been identified.[37]

Jack or Yochanan? Benjamin's gravestone in Philadelphia calls him "Dov Ber son of R. Yochanan." His father was *Jankel* on the 1906 list, which can only be Yaakov (Jacob), but in America he was known as **Jack**, which is also the familiar form of John, in Hebrew *Yochanan*. Benjamin died in 1940, when Doris was thirteen; whoever ordered his stone may have turned "Jack" back into Hebrew as Yochanan. This is an inference.

Benjamin and Catherine in Philadelphia

In 1910 Benjamin married **Catherine (Katie) Saslow**, then a hosiery worker of about 19, living with her parents on South Fifth Street. The Philadelphia licence, number 260214, was issued to "Beny Zaslof" and "Katie Saslow"; Katie was still single on census day, 15 April 1910, so they married later that year.[38] Benjamin became a grocer, and by 1921 the family lived at **2163 East Cambria Street**, where he kept a fruit store. He was naturalized on 10 March 1924; the witness to his petition was "B. Saslow," paperhanger, of 2208 South Fifth Street: his father-in-law.[32]

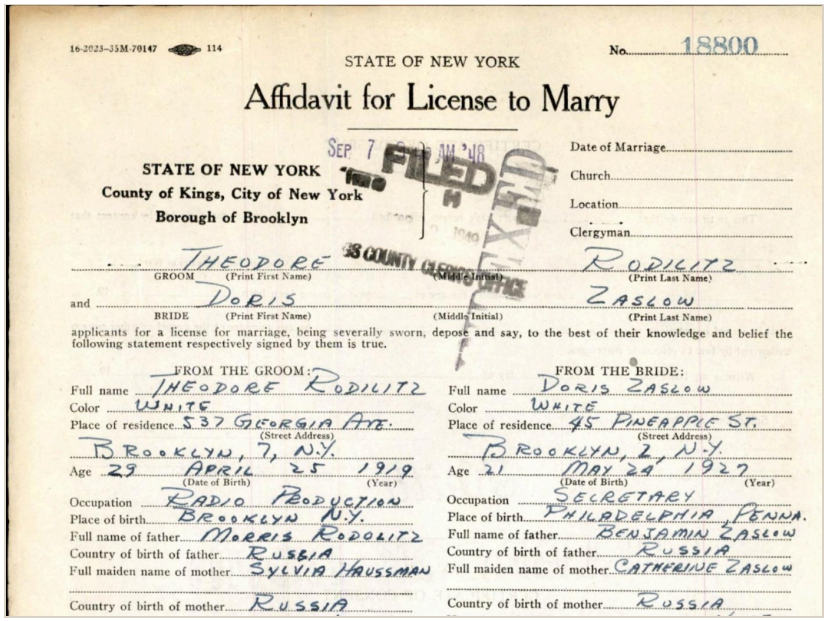
They had four children: **Sylvia**, born on 22 December 1911; **Edward**, born on 30 December 1918; **Mildred**, born in December 1923, who died aged two months on 16 February 1924 at her grandparents' house on South Fifth Street; and **Doris**, born on 24 May 1926.[39]

Catherine died on 5 September 1937, aged 46, and was buried at Har Jehuda beside her father; her Hebrew name on her stone is *Beila daughter of Dov*. Benjamin died of lung cancer at the Jewish Hospital on 29 February 1940 and was buried at Har Jehuda on 3 March. His stone, in Hebrew, reads *Dov Ber son of R. Yochanan*, died 20 Adar I 5700. Doris was eleven when her mother died and thirteen when her father died.[40]

Part six

Theodore and Doris

Theodore Rodilitz and Doris Zaslow took out their marriage licence in Brooklyn on 7 September 1948, licence number 18800. He was 29, in radio production, still living with his parents at 537 Georgia Avenue; she was a secretary living in Brooklyn Heights. The licence gives Doris's birth as 24 May 1927 in Philadelphia.[41] He came from a family that had left the Kobrin district between 1907 and 1913; she was a Philadelphian whose grandparents had come from Podolia in 1892–93 and 1906. Doris had roots in Brooklyn too: her Zaslow grandparents had lived in Brownsville and East New York, close to the Rodilitzes' streets, until their deaths in 1930 and 1931. How she and Theodore met is not known.



16-2023-35M-70147 114

STATE OF NEW YORK

No. 18800

Affidavit for License to Marry

SEP 7 FILED

STATE OF NEW YORK
County of Kings, City of New York
Borough of Brooklyn

Date of Marriage
Church
Location
Clergyman

GROOM THEODORE (Print First Name) (Middle Initial) RODILITZ (Print Last Name)

and BRIDE DORIS (Print First Name) (Middle Initial) ZASLOW (Print Last Name)

applicants for a license for marriage, being severally sworn, depose and say, to the best of their knowledge and belief the following statement respectively signed by them is true.

FROM THE GROOM:		FROM THE BRIDE:	
Full name	THEODORE RODILITZ	Full name	DORIS ZASLOW
Color	WHITE	Color	WHITE
Place of residence	537 GEORGIA AVE. (Street Address) BROOKLYN, 7, N.Y.	Place of residence	45 PINEAPPLE ST. (Street Address) BROOKLYN, 2, N.Y.
Age	29 APRIL 25 1919 (Date of Birth) (Year)	Age	21 MAY 24 1927 (Date of Birth) (Year)
Occupation	RADIO PRODUCTION	Occupation	SECRETARY
Place of birth	BROOKLYN N.Y.	Place of birth	PHILADELPHIA, PENNA.
Full name of father	MORRIS RODILITZ	Full name of father	BENJAMIN ZASLOW
Country of birth of father	RUSSIA	Country of birth of father	RUSSIA
Full maiden name of mother	SYLVIA HAUSSMAN	Full maiden name of mother	CATHERINE ZASLOW
Country of birth of mother	RUSSIA	Country of birth of mother	RUSSIA

Affidavit for licence to marry, Brooklyn, 7 September 1948 (upper part). It names Theodore's parents as Morris Rodilitz and Sylvia Hausman and Doris's as Benjamin Zaslow and Catherine, all born in Russia. NYC Municipal Archives, L-K-1948-0018800.

By 1968 Theodore was registered to vote in Orange County, California, and he and Doris made their home in Anaheim. Theodore died on 11 January 2004, aged 84, and Doris on 25 February 2007.[42]

Their daughter **Sylvia** married **Victor E. Koik** . Through that marriage the Rodilitzes and Zaslows of Kobrin and Podolia joined the Koik family, whose own history, from Estonia, is told in *The Leoke and Koik Families*.

Appendix A

Chronology

Date	Family	Event
1855, 15 May	**Zaslow**	Jacob (Jack) Zaslow born, son of David Zaslow and Katia Goldberg
1865, June	**Saslow**	Benjamin (Dov) Saslow born, son of David
1867, March	**Saslow**	Bessie (Batya) Weiss born, daughter of Harry (Aharon) Weiss and Molly Gold
1869, 25 December	**Rodilitz**	Mary (Miriam) Prozansky born, daughter of Abraham and Ida
1871, 15 March	**Rodilitz**	Jacob Rodilitz born at Kovel, Volhynia
1876	**Zaslow**	Itzik (Ike) Zaslawer born
1885, 8 January	**Zaslow**	Benjamin Zaslow (Dov Ber) born at Obodovka, Podolia
1886, 15 September	**Zaslow**	Herman (Hyman) Zaslow born at Obodovka
1889, December	**Saslow**	Beckie (Jety) Saslow born
1890, 17 April	**Rodilitz**	Morris (Motel) Rodilitz born; later gives his home as Czerniany
1891, April	**Saslow**	Catherine (Beile) Saslow born
about 1892	**Hausman**	Sylvia Hausman born, Grodno province
1892	**Saslow**	Benjamin Saslow emigrates to America
1892–1907	**Rodilitz**	Harry, Meyer, Benny, Ida, Esther, Louis and Sarah born, at Maciejów(?), Kobrin and Brest
1893, 16 June	**Saslow**	Bessie with Beckie and Catherine leaves Hamburg, the month Hamburg bans Russian steerage passengers
1893, 3 July	**Saslow**	They land at Ellis Island from Glasgow on the *Circassia*, bound for Philadelphia
1902, 15 December	**Saslow**	Benjamin Saslow naturalized in Philadelphia
1904, 14 March	**Zaslow**	The *Haverford* lands at Philadelphia with Itzik, Berl and David Saslawer; Benjamin Zaslow swore he arrived on 15 March
1906, 6 August	**Zaslow**	Jacob and Miriam Zaslawer and Ruchle land at Ellis Island on the *Umbria*
1907, 27 April	**Rodilitz**	Jacob Rodilitz sails from Rotterdam on the *Rijndam*; arrives 7–9 May
1907, 16 December	**Rodilitz**	Morris lands from Bremen on the *Breslau*
1910	**Hausman**	Sylvia Hausman comes to America (year from censuses)
1909, 3 August	**Prozansky**	Mary's brother Moishe Velvel Prozansky lands from Antwerp on the *Kroonland*, leaving her in Divin
1910, 12 June	**Rodilitz**	Harry lands from Hamburg on the *Cleveland*

Date	Family	Event
1910	**Zaslow**	Benjamin Zaslow and Catherine Saslow marry in Philadelphia
1911, 31 July	**Rodilitz**	Meyer lands on the *Rotterdam*
1911, 22 December	**Zaslow**	Sylvia Zaslow born, Philadelphia
1912, 2–3 July	**Rodilitz**	Benny lands from Rotterdam on the *Potsdam*
1913, 22 December	**Rodilitz**	Mary lands from Hamburg on the *Pretoria* with Ida, Esther, Louis and Sarah
1914, 26 August	**Saslow**	Beckie Mitchell née Saslow dies, aged 25
1915, June	**Rodilitz**	All ten of Jacob's family together at 115 Malta St, Brooklyn
1915, 7 November	**Rodilitz**	Morris Rodilitz marries Sylvia Hausman at 41 Malta St
1918, 30 December	**Zaslow**	Edward Zaslow born
1919, 25 April	**Rodilitz**	Theodore Rodilitz born, Brooklyn
1924, 10 March	**Zaslow**	Benjamin Zaslow naturalized; his father-in-law is his witness
1925, 12 May	**Hausman**	Rose Hausman lands from Havana on the *Ebro*
1926, 24 May	**Zaslow**	Doris Zaslow born, Philadelphia
1929, February	**Rodilitz**	Jacob Rodilitz naturalized
1930, 9 July	**Zaslow**	Jack Zaslow dies in Brooklyn
1931, 14 September	**Zaslow**	Miriam Zaslow dies in Brooklyn
1932, 15 November	**Hausman**	Rose Hausman dies in the Bronx
1934, 14 April	**Rodilitz**	Mary Rodilitz dies at 188 Malta St
1936, 8 May	**Saslow**	Bessie Saslow dies
1937, 19 July	**Saslow**	Benjamin Saslow dies
1937, 5 September	**Zaslow**	Catherine Zaslow dies
1940, 29 February	**Zaslow**	Benjamin Zaslow dies
1948, 7 September	**Both**	Theodore Rodilitz and Doris Zaslow take out a marriage licence in Brooklyn
1950, 14–15 June	**Rodilitz**	Jacob Rodilitz dies; buried beside Mary at Montefiore
1952, 14 December	**Hausman**	Sylvia Rodilitz née Hausman dies
1957, 6 January	**Rodilitz**	Morris Rodilitz dies
1982, March	**Prozansky**	Morris W. Rosen (Moishe Velvel Prozansky) dies in Los Angeles (probable)
2004, 11 January	**Both**	Theodore Rodilitz dies, Anaheim, California
2007, 25 February	**Both**	Doris Rodilitz née Zaslow dies

Appendix B

Those who stayed behind, 1914–1945

Every one of these families left Europe between 1892 and 1925. Relatives who stayed lived through the First World War, the redrawing of borders, and the Holocaust. No individual relative has yet been traced: searches of Yad Vashem's database of Holocaust victims under about 28 spellings of Rodilitz, and under Zaslavsky, Saslow and Hausman in the home towns, found no one who can be linked to the family. The Lesnoff name, found after those searches, has not yet been checked. Memorial books do list Prozansky families killed in Antopol, Khomsk and Kamen-Kashirsky, all within about 50 km of Divin, but none is known to be Mary's.[43]

The First World War. In August 1915 the retreating Russian army abandoned Kovel and Brest-Litovsk and ordered the Jews of the front zone east; Brest's Jews were expelled on 1 August 1915. The peace between Germany and Soviet Russia was signed at Brest-Litovsk on 3 March 1918.

Between the wars. Brest, Kobrin, Divin, Kovel and Maciejów became part of Poland in 1919–21, after fighting around Kobrin and Kovel in September 1920. Tulchin and Obodovka stayed in Soviet Ukraine. In 1919, during the civil war, pogroms killed about 170 Jews in Tulchin and between 150 and 300 in Obodovka.

The Holocaust in the Kobrin district. Germany invaded on 22 June 1941 and reached Kobrin the next day. About 8,000 Jews were confined in two ghettos. One was destroyed in the summer of 1942, when about 1,800 people were shot at Bronnaya Gora; the other on 14–15 October 1942, when about 4,000–4,500 were shot beside the Kobrin–Divin road. About 6,900 Kobrin Jews were murdered. Divin's Jews were confined in a ghetto and killed in 1942, and Czerniany's hundred or so Jews were shot in the spring or summer of that year.

Brest. Brest had about 21,500 Jews in 1936. About 5,000 men were shot in the summer of 1941. The ghetto, set up in December 1941 with about 18,000 people, was destroyed on 15 October 1942, most of its people being killed at Bronnaya Gora. Only a handful of Jews, perhaps ten to twenty, were alive in the city when it was liberated in July 1944.

Kovel and Maciejów. Kovel's ghetto was set up in May 1942 and destroyed between June and October 1942. In Maciejów, which had about 2,600 Jews in 1941, about 1,000 were shot in the quarry in August 1941, and the ghetto was destroyed in the late summer of 1942.

Tulchin and Obodovka. Southern Podolia came under Romanian rule as part of "Transnistria." Tulchin's Jews were confined in September 1941 and about 3,000 were sent to the camp at Pechora, where most died. Obodovka received about 10,000–11,000 Jews deported from Bessarabia and Bukovina in November 1941; thousands died there of typhus and hunger. What happened to Obodovka's own few hundred Jews is not recorded separately.

The families that left between 1892 and 1925 escaped all of this. Any relatives who stayed in Kobrin, Divin or Brest would almost certainly have been killed in 1942.[51]

Appendix C

Places connected with the families

In Europe

Place	Connection	Notes for a visit
Kobrin, Divin, Czerniany, Brest	The Rodilitz and Hausman home towns	Belarus. Kobrin's Jewish history is told in the Kobrin Yizkor book, in English on JewishGen
Kovel, Maciejów (Lukiv)	Jacob Rodilitz's birthplace and home	Volyn region, Ukraine
Tulchin, Obodovka, Bershad	Probably the Saslows' town (Tulchin); the Zaslows' town (Obodovka); Ike Zaslow's burial society (Bershad)	Vinnytsia region, Ukraine
Terespol, Włodawa, Chełm	The nearest places in Poland: Terespol faces Brest across the Bug, about 40 km from Czerniany; Włodawa has a preserved 18th-century synagogue complex, now a museum; Maciejów is about 40 km east of the Dorohusk crossing near Chełm	Poland
Hamburg	Harry (1910) and Mary with the four youngest (1913)	BallinStadt emigration museum, on the site of the emigrant halls
Bremerhaven	Morris (1907)	German Emigration Center
Rotterdam	Jacob (1907), Meyer (1911), Benny (1912)	Hotel New York, the former Holland-America Line offices; Fenix migration museum
Hamburg and Glasgow	Bessie Saslow and her daughters (1893)	
London, Leman Street	The Zaslawer brothers spent three months in London before sailing in 1904	Site of the Jews' Temporary Shelter, Whitechapel
Liverpool	Benjamin Zaslow (1904) and his parents (1906) sailed from here	Pier Head; the Merseyside Maritime Museum is closed until 2028

In America

Place	Connection	Notes for a visit
Ellis Island	Arrival of most of the family, 1893–1925	Statue of Liberty National Monument
70 Orchard St, Manhattan	The address on the probable passenger-list line for Jacob, 1907	A block from the Tenement Museum, 97 Orchard St
326 Snediker Ave, 721 Vienna Ave, 115 and 188 Malta St, 41 Malta St, 537 Georgia Ave, Brooklyn	The Rodilitz homes and synagogue, 1907–1940s	East New York; much changed
98 Barrett St, Chester St, Brooklyn	Jack and Miriam Zaslow's homes	Brownsville and East New York
Montefiore Cemetery, Springfield Gardens, Queens	Jacob and Mary Rodilitz, Block 11, row 7L, graves 1–2; Jack and Miriam Zaslow, Block 32, row 13R, graves 25–26; Ike Zaslow	Photographs of the Zaslow stones would show Jack's Hebrew name
New Montefiore Cemetery, West Babylon	Morris and Sylvia; Meyer, Harry and Louis, in the "Jacob & Miriam Rose Rodolitz" plot, Block 15	Long Island
Pier 53, Washington Ave, Philadelphia	Benjamin Zaslow landed here in 1904	Site of the Washington Avenue immigration station; now a park
787 S. 3rd St, 2208 S. 5th St, 2163 E. Cambria St, Philadelphia	The Saslow and Zaslow homes	South and North Philadelphia
Har Jehuda Cemetery, Upper Darby	Benjamin and Bessie Saslow; Catherine and Benjamin Zaslow; baby Mildred	The cemetery's burial registers are at Temple University's Special Collections
Anaheim, California	Theodore and Doris's home	

Appendix D

Family and record details

Rodilitz

Jacob Rodilitz (Jankel Rodeletz; Hebrew *Yaakov*), son of Yonah, born 15 March 1871 at Kovel; Hebrew teacher; arrived 1907; naturalized 1929 (certificate 2898975); died 14–15 June 1950; buried Montefiore. **Mary (Miriam Reizel, Rose)**, née Prozansky (Pruzansky, Porojinsky), born 25 December 1869, daughter of Abraham and Ida; arrived 1913; died 14 April 1934; buried Montefiore. Her brother **Moishe Velvel Prozansky** (Morris William Rosen), born 1892, arrived 1909, died in Los Angeles about 1982.

Their children: **Morris** (Motel), 1890–1957, married Sylvia Hausman (1915). **Harry** (Hersch; Hebrew *Tzvi Hersh*), 1892–1967, married Fannie Bunder (1919); their sons Abraham Jonas (1920–1998) and Stanley (1927–1936), who is buried at Montefiore, like his grandmother. **Meyer** (Meier), 1894–1950, a plumber, married Henrietta Frankel (1932). **Benny** (Berl, Benjamin), 1896. **Ida** (Chaje), 1898, married Irving Hovelin (1927). **Esther**, 1900 or 1903, married Sol Feinberg (1927). **Louis** (Leib), 1905–1970, married Gertrude Kaplan (1934). **Sarah** (Sure), 1907, married Martin Gordon (1929), himself born in Kobrin.

Hausman

Joseph Hausman, died before 1925. **Rose (Reise)**, née Shapiro, born about 1865, probably at Brest-Litovsk; daughter of William Sapir(?) and Hannah Katz; arrived from Havana 1925; died in the Bronx 15 November 1932. Their daughters: **Sylvia** (Sivia), about 1892–1952, married Morris Rodilitz; **Fega**, in Havana in 1925; and a married daughter, **G. Weisberg**, of the Bronx.

Saslow

Benjamin (Dov) Saslow, son of David, born June 1865; paperhanger; arrived 1892; naturalized 1902; died 19 July 1937. **Bessie (Basche, Batya)**, née Weiss, born March 1867, daughter of Harry (Aharon) Weiss and Molly Gold; arrived 1893; died 8 May 1936. Children: **Beckie** (Jety), 1889–1914, married David Mitchell; **Catherine** (Beile, Katie), 1891–1937, married Benjamin Zaslow; **Louis**, 1893 or 1895–1965; **Herman**, 1896; **Mollie**, 1899. Six children were born by 1900, five of them living.

Zaslow

Jacob (Jankel, Jack) Zaslow (Zaslawer, Soslawer), son of David Zaslow and Katia Goldberg, born 15 May 1855; arrived 1906; dry goods merchant (probably the "Reverend" Jacob of the 1920 census, at 220 Livonia Avenue); died 9 July 1930. **Miriam (Marjem, Mary)**, née Lesnoff, daughter of Herman and Rose Lesnoff, born 1848 or about 1854; died 14 September 1931. Nine children, seven living in 1910, among them: **Itzik (Ike)**, 1876–1940; **Benjamin** (Dov Ber, probably Berl), 1885–1940, married Catherine Saslow; **Herman (Hyman)**, 1886–1958; **Ruchle**, about 1889; and probably **David**, the third brother of 1904 (unidentified).

Benjamin and Catherine's children: **Sylvia**, 1911; **Edward**, 1918; **Mildred**, 1923–1924; **Doris**, 1926–2007, married Theodore Rodilitz.

Hebrew names on the gravestones

Person	Inscription (in translation)	Hebrew date of death
Jacob Rodilitz (Montefiore)	Yaakov son of R. Yonah	1st day Rosh Chodesh Tammuz 5710 (15 June 1950)
Mary Rodilitz (Montefiore)	Miriam Reizel daughter of R. Avraham	29 Nisan 5694 (14 April 1934)
Abraham J. Rodolitz (New Montefiore)	Avraham Yonah son of R. Tzvi Hersh	1998
Benjamin Saslow (Har Jehuda)	Dov son of R. David	11 Av 5697 (19 July 1937)
Bessie Saslow (Har Jehuda)	Batya daughter of R. Aharon	16 Iyar 5696 (8 May 1936)
Catherine Zaslow (Har Jehuda)	Beila daughter of R. Dov	29 Elul 5697 (5 September 1937)
Benjamin Zaslow (Har Jehuda)	Dov Ber son of R. Yochanan דוב בער ב"ר יוחנן	20 Adar I 5700 (29 February 1940)

Read from photographs on Find a Grave; Benjamin Zaslow's inscription has now been read twice. "R." is the customary honorific before a father's name.

Appendix E

Open questions and further research

The most useful records still to get

- **The 1910 Philadelphia marriage licence** of Benjamin Zaslow and Katie Saslow (no. 260214), held by the Philadelphia Register of Wills. It names both sets of parents and should confirm that Benjamin was the son of Jacob and Miriam Zaslawer of Brooklyn.
- **Moishe Velvel Prozansky's veteran's file.** The Department of Veterans Affairs sends a free summary of a dead veteran's file, including his parents' names; his would name Mary's parents. A request is drafted.
- **Jacob Rodilitz's 1950 death certificate**, which should give his mother's name.
- **Photographs of Jack and Ike Zaslow's gravestones** at Montefiore, to settle whether Jack's Hebrew name was Yaakov or Yochanan.
- **The Har Jehuda burial registers** at Temple University, for the Saslow and Zaslow burials of 1936–1940.
- **Rose Hausman's immigration file**, which may explain how she entered from Cuba in 1925 and name her husband's place and date of death.

Questions

- **Who was B. Rozankrans**, Jacob's brother-in-law at 70 Orchard Street in 1907, who paid his passage? Possibly a relative of Mary's Prozansky family; an Abraham Pruzensky, born about 1867, was living in Harlem in 1905 (an unverified lead).
- **Where was the Rodilitz home before 1907:** Maciejów, Czerniany, Kobrin, Divin, or several of these in turn?
- **When and how did Sylvia Hausman come to America** in about 1910?
- **Who was David Saslawer**, the youngest of the three brothers on the *Haverford*, and who was "S. Weisberg" of Amsterdam Avenue?
- **Who raised Doris** after her father's death in 1940, when she was thirteen?
- **The European records.** JewishGen has no Rodilitz or Prozansky records for Kobrin, Divin or Kovel: those registers are not yet indexed. The originals are in Belarus and Ukraine; letters are drafted.

Reference

Sources and notes

This history, in its second edition, draws on research carried out in October 2026 for the Rodilitz–Zaslow research files, in which every source has a code (RZ-S01 and so on) and a permanent link. The notes below cite the records for each statement; codes beginning RZ-T refer to the research reports in the same files. Ancestry links need a subscription; NYC Municipal Archives certificates and the Rotterdam registers are free online.

Archives and record collections. NYC Municipal Archives, Historical Vital Records (certificates of birth, marriage and death, Kings and Bronx counties). National Archives (NARA): passenger lists of vessels arriving at New York (M237, T715) and Philadelphia (T840); naturalization records of the US District Courts for the Eastern Districts of New York and Pennsylvania; federal censuses 1900–1940. New York State censuses 1915 and 1925. Pennsylvania death certificates. Stadsarchief Rotterdam, Holland-America Line archive 318-04, registers of passage money. Hamburg passenger lists. Har Jehuda Cemetery burial registers. Montefiore and New Montefiore cemeteries, interment searches. FamilySearch (passenger lists, naturalization indexes, the National Homes for Disabled Volunteer Soldiers registers, WWII draft cards, California Death Index). JewishGen databases. Statue of Liberty–Ellis Island Foundation passenger database. Find a Grave. The family's Ancestry tree (export of 22 October 2026).

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Notes

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12. Certificate of death no. 8531, Mary Rodlitz, Brooklyn, 14 April 1934, NYC Municipal Archives D-K-1934-0008531 (RZ-S02), a860-historicalvitalrecords.nyc.gov/view/6285818. Birth date 25 December 1869: Jacob's petition (RZ-S38). Birthplace Kobryn: passenger list, SS *Pretoria*, 1913 (RZ-S61).
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37. Certificate of death no. 8348, Ike Zaslow, Brooklyn, 1940, a860-historicalvitalrecords.nyc.gov/view/6883613 (RZ-S79); *Brooklyn Daily Eagle*, 1922 (Bershider Benevolent Society); WWII draft registration, Herman Zaslow (RZ-S81).
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39. Petition for naturalization, 1923 (RZ-S23); US census, 1930 (RZ-S24); Pennsylvania certificate of death, Mildred Zaslow, 1924 (RZ-S47); Social Security Applications and Claims Index, Doris Zaslow (RZ-S08.15, RZ-S10). AncientFaces gives her birth year as 1927; the Social Security record and the 1930 census (age 3) support 1926.
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